

Absolutely — **critical** is exactly the sort of word that benefits from the fuller reference treatment because several very common meanings can point in almost opposite directions.

Your passage uses the adverb:

> “...it taught me to view social media more **critically** and more calmly.”

Here **critically** does **not** mean “in a negative or disapproving way”. It means **carefully, analytically, and with independent judgement instead of simply accepting things at face value**.

Word family: **critical / critically / critic / criticism / criticize / critique**

Base adjective: critical

Adverb: critically

Related noun: critic

Related noun: criticism

Related verb: criticize

Related noun/verb: critique

Part of speech: adjective (形容詞) / adverb (副詞) / related noun and verb family

Meaning in your passage: **critically** = analytically / with careful judgement — 批判性地；審慎分析地

Your sentence:

> “...to view social media more **critically** and more calmly.”

Here **critically** means:

> **to examine social media carefully, question its effects and assumptions, and form an independent judgement rather than accepting it unthinkingly.**

繁體中文：

以分析、質疑、判斷和評估的方式看待，而不是盲目接受

Natural translation:

> “view social media more critically”

「以更**批判性 / 審慎分析的角度**看待社交媒體」

So here:

> ****critically = 運用獨立判斷，仔細分析優點、問題、證據和影響****

A. ANALYTICAL JUDGEMENT

1. ****critical = involving careful analysis and judgement — 批判性的；分析性的****

This is the adjective corresponding most closely to your source.

Practice 1

> “Students need ****critical**** thinking skills.”

「學生需要****批判性思考能力****。」

Practice 2

> “She took a critical approach to the information online.”

「她以****批判性分析的方式****看待網上資訊。」

****critical = 不盲目接受，而是分析證據、假設、邏輯及不同觀點的****

2. ****critically = analytically / evaluatively — 批判性地；審慎地****

Your exact source sense.

Practice 3 — Original

> “I learned to view social media more ****critically****.”

「我學會以更****批判性的方式****看待社交媒體。」

Practice 4

> “Read the article critically rather than accepting every claim.”

「閱讀文章時要****審慎分析****，不要接受每一個說法。」

****critically = 透過分析、質疑和評估作出獨立判斷****

3. **critical thinking = 批判性思考**

A major educational/academic compound.

Practice 5

> “The course develops **critical thinking**.”

「這門課培養**批判性思考**。」

Practice 6

> “Critical thinking involves evaluating evidence.”

「**批判性思考**包括評估證據。」

critical thinking = 系統地分析資訊、判斷證據、辨識假設和形成合理結論的能力

4. **critical analysis = 批判性分析**

Practice 7

> “The essay requires a **critical analysis** of the argument.”

「這篇文章要求對該論證作**批判性分析**。」

Practice 8

> “A critical analysis should examine both strengths and weaknesses.”

「**批判性分析**應同時檢視優點和缺點。」

critical analysis = 不只是描述內容，而是評估其理據、證據、局限和含意

5. **critical evaluation = 批判性評估；審慎評價**

Practice 9

> “The assignment asks for a **critical evaluation** of the theory.”

「作業要求對這套理論作**批判性評估**。」

Practice 10

> “Critical evaluation requires evidence, not just opinion.”

「**批判性評估**需要證據，而不只是個人意見。」

6. **critical reading = 批判性閱讀**

Practice 11

> “Critical reading helps students identify weak arguments.”

「**批判性閱讀**有助學生辨認薄弱論證。」

Practice 12

> “She read the report critically.”

「她以**批判性閱讀方式**閱讀報告。」

B. DISAPPROVING / FINDING FAULT

7. **critical = expressing disapproval — 批評的；挑剔的**

A major distinct meaning.

Practice 13

> “His parents were very **critical** of his decision.”

「他的父母對他的決定非常**批評 / 不滿**。」

Practice 14

> “The review was highly critical of the film.”

「那篇評論對這部電影提出了強烈**批評**。」

****critical = 明確指出錯誤、缺點或問題，通常帶負面評價****

8. **critical of + person/thing = 對.....持批評態度**

Practice 15

> “She is **critical of** the way the platform handles privacy.”

「她對這個平台處理私隱的方式**持批評態度**。」

Practice 16

> “Many users were critical of the update.”

「很多使用者都**批評**這次更新。」

be critical of X = 認為 X 有問題並公開 / 明確表達不滿

9. **critically = in a disapproving way — 批評地；挑剔地**

Practice 17

> “He looked critically at the design.”

「他用**挑剔 / 審視的眼光**看著這個設計。」

Practice 18

> “She spoke critically about the proposal.”

「她以**批評的態度**談論那項提議。」

Here context can overlap with analytical judgement.

C. CRUCIAL / ESSENTIAL

10. **critical = extremely important — 關鍵的；至關重要的**

One of the most common modern meanings.

Practice 19

> “Timing is **critical**.”

「時間掌握**至關重要**。」

Practice 20

> “Trust is critical to a successful relationship.”

「信任對成功的關係**至關重要**。」

critical = 對結果具有決定性影響、不能忽視的

11. **critical to/for + result = 對.....至關重要**

Practice 21

> “Quality is **critical to** the bakery’s success.”

「品質對麵包店的成功**至關重要**。」

Practice 22

> “Accurate data is critical for good decisions.”

「準確數據對良好決策**極其重要**。」

12. **critical factor = 關鍵因素**

Practice 23

> “Customer trust is a **critical factor**.”

「顧客信任是一個**關鍵因素**。」

Practice 24

> “Cost is a critical factor in the decision.”

「成本是這項決定中的**關鍵因素**。」

13. **critical issue = 關鍵問題；重大議題**

Practice 25

> “Online privacy is a **critical issue**.”

「網絡私隱是一個**重大 / 關鍵議題**。」

Practice 26

> “The meeting focused on several critical issues.”

「會議集中討論幾個**重要問題**。」

14. **critical stage** = 關鍵階段

Practice 27

> “The project has entered a **critical stage**.”

「這個項目已進入**關鍵階段**。」

Practice 28

> “Early childhood is a critical stage of development.”

「幼兒時期是發展的**關鍵階段**。」

15. **critical moment** = 關鍵時刻

Practice 29

> “She remained calm at the **critical moment**.”

「她在**關鍵時刻**保持冷靜。」

Practice 30

> “The system failed at a critical moment.”

「系統在**關鍵時刻**失靈。」

D. DANGEROUS / SERIOUS MEDICAL CONDITION

16. **critical = extremely serious / life-threatening — 危急的；情況嚴重的**

A major medical/safety meaning.

Practice 31

> “The patient is in **critical condition**.”

「病人情況**危殆 / 危急**。」

Practice 32

> “Two people remained critically injured.”

「兩人仍然**傷勢危重**。」

critical = 情況極嚴重，可能危及生命

17. **critical condition = 危殆狀態；危急情況**

Practice 33

> “He was taken to hospital in **critical condition**.”

「他被送院時情況**危殆**。」

Practice 34

> “Her condition remains critical.”

「她的情況仍然**危急**。」

18. **critically ill = 病危；病情嚴重**

Practice 35

> “The patient is **critically ill**.”

「病人**病情危重**。」

Practice 36

> “Critically ill patients require intensive monitoring.”

「**病情危重的患者**需要密切監察。」

19. **critically injured = 傷勢危重**

Practice 37

> “Three passengers were **critically injured**.”

「三名乘客**傷勢危重**。」

Practice 38

> “He was critically injured in the accident.”

「他在事故中受到**危及生命的重傷**。」

E. CRITICAL CARE / MEDICINE

20. **critical care = 重症醫療；危重症照護**

Practice 39

> “She works in **critical care**.”

「她從事**重症醫療**工作。」

Practice 40

> “Critical care patients require constant observation.”

「**重症病人**需要持續監察。」

critical care = 為生命狀況不穩定 / 危重患者提供的高度密集醫療照護

21. **critical care unit = 重症監護病房**

Practice 41

> “He was moved to the **critical care unit**.”

「他被轉到**重症監護病房**。」

Practice 42

> “The hospital expanded its critical care unit.”

「醫院擴充了**重症照護病房**。」

F. CRITICS / REVIEWS / ARTS

22. **critical** = relating to professional critics — 評論界的；評論家的

A major arts/media meaning.

Practice 43

> “The film received **critical acclaim**.”

「這部電影獲得**影評界高度讚譽**。」

Practice 44

> “The book was a critical success.”

「這本書在**評論界獲得成功**。」

critical = 與專業評論家及其評價有關的

This is different from “negative”.

23. **critical acclaim** = 評論界高度讚譽

Practice 45

> “The album received widespread **critical acclaim**.”

「這張專輯獲得評論界廣泛**好評**。」

Practice 46

> “The performance won critical acclaim.”

「這場演出贏得評論界**高度讚譽**。」

Important:

> **critical acclaim** does **not** mean “harsh criticism”.

It means:

> critics praised it.

Excellent MCQ trap.

24. **critical success = 評論界成功；叫好**

Practice 47

> “The film was a **critical success** but not a commercial one.”

「這部電影**叫好但不叫座**。」

Practice 48

> “The novel became a critical success.”

「這本小說獲得評論界**高度肯定**。」

25. **critical reception = 評論界反應**

Practice 49

> “The film’s **critical reception** was mixed.”

「這部電影的**評論界反應**褒貶不一。」

Practice 50

> “Its critical reception improved over time.”

「隨時間過去，評論界對它的**評價**有所改善。」

G. CRITIC

26. **critic = person who professionally reviews art/media — 評論家；評論員**

Practice 51

> “Film **critics** praised the performance.”

「電影**評論家**讚揚了這場演出。」

Practice 52

> “She works as a theatre critic.”

「她是一名戲劇**評論家**。」

****critic = 專門分析和評價電影、書籍、藝術、音樂等的人****

27. **critic = person who expresses opposition/disapproval — 批評者；反對者**

Practice 53

> “He is a strong **critic** of the policy.”

「他是這項政策的強烈**批評者**。」

Practice 54

> “Critics questioned the plan’s cost.”

「**批評者**質疑這項計劃的成本。」

****critic = 經常或公開指出某人 / 事物問題的人****

H. CRITICISM

28. **criticism = negative judgement / fault-finding — 批評；批判**

Practice 55

> “The video attracted some harsh ****criticism****.”

「這段影片招來了一些尖銳的****批評****。」

Practice 56

> “She accepted the criticism calmly.”

「她平靜地接受了****批評****。」

****criticism = 指出錯誤、缺點或問題的負面評價****

29. **criticism = analytical evaluation — 評論；批評研究******

A broader academic/arts sense.

Practice 57

> “Literary ****criticism**** examines how texts work.”

「文學****批評 / 評論研究****探討文本如何運作。」

Practice 58

> “The course introduces modern art criticism.”

「這門課介紹現代藝術****評論****。」

Here criticism does not necessarily mean negative fault-finding.

30. **constructive criticism = 建設性批評******

Practice 59

> “Good feedback includes ****constructive criticism****.”

「好的回饋包括****建設性批評****。」

Practice 60

> “She used the criticism to improve her work.”

「她利用這些**建設性意見**改善自己的作品。」

constructive criticism = 以指出問題來幫助改進，而不是單純攻擊

I. CRITICIZE

31. **criticize** = express disapproval / point out faults — 批評；指責

Practice 61

> “People online **criticized** his appearance.”

「網民**批評**他的外表。」

Practice 62

> “The report criticized the company’s lack of transparency.”

「報告**批評**公司缺乏透明度。」

criticize = 明確指出某人 / 某事的問題、錯誤或缺點

32. **criticize someone for + noun/-ing** = 因……批評某人

Practice 63

> “She was criticized for posting the video.”

「她因發布那段影片而受到**批評**。」

Practice 64

> “The company was criticized for delaying the response.”

「公司因延遲回應而受到**批評**。」

J. CRITIQUE

33. **critique = detailed analytical evaluation — 評析；批判性評論**

Practice 65

> “The essay offers a **critique** of social media culture.”

「這篇文章對社交媒體文化作出**批判性評析**。」

Practice 66

> “Her critique examines both the strengths and weaknesses of the theory.”

「她的**評析**檢視了理論的優點和缺點。」

****critique = 有系統地分析和評價一項作品、觀點、制度或理論****

Not necessarily negative.

34. **critique = verb, critically evaluate — 評析；作批判性評價**

Practice 67

> “Students were asked to **critique** the article.”

「學生被要求**評析**這篇文章。」

Practice 68

> “The report critiques current practices.”

「報告對目前做法作出**批判性分析**。」

K. MISSION / SYSTEM IMPORTANCE

35. **mission-critical = 任務關鍵的；不能失效的**

A major technical/business compound.

Practice 69

> “The hospital relies on **mission-critical systems**.”

「醫院依賴**任務關鍵 / 不可中斷的系統**。」

Practice 70

> “The server supports mission-critical operations.”

「這台伺服器支援**關鍵營運工作**。」

mission-critical = 對核心任務不可或缺，一旦失效就會嚴重影響運作的

36. **business-critical = 業務關鍵的**

Practice 71

> “Customer data is stored in a **business-critical system**.”

「客戶資料儲存在一個**業務關鍵系統**中。」

Practice 72

> “The outage affected business-critical processes.”

「故障影響了**關鍵業務流程**。」

37. **safety-critical = 安全關鍵的**

Practice 73

> “The software controls a **safety-critical system**.”

「這套軟件控制一個**安全關鍵系統**。」

Practice 74

> “Safety-critical equipment requires rigorous testing.”

「**安全關鍵設備**需要嚴格測試。」

safety-critical = 故障可能造成嚴重人身 / 安全後果的

L. CRITICAL INFRASTRUCTURE

38. **critical infrastructure = 關鍵基礎設施**

Practice 75

> “Power grids are part of **critical infrastructure**.”

「電網屬於**關鍵基礎設施**。」

Practice 76

> “The plan protects critical infrastructure from cyberattack.”

「這項計劃保護**關鍵基礎設施**免受網絡攻擊。」

critical infrastructure = 社會 / 國家正常運作所必需的重要系統和設施

Examples:

- * energy
- * water
- * transport
- * communications

M. CRITICAL PATH / PROJECT MANAGEMENT

39. **critical path = 關鍵路徑**

A major project-management term.

Practice 77

> “The delay affected the project’s **critical path**.”

「延誤影響了項目的**關鍵路徑**。」

Practice 78

> “Tasks on the critical path cannot be delayed without affecting completion.”

「**關鍵路徑**上的任務一旦延誤，就會影響整個項目的完成時間。」

critical path = 決定項目最短完成時間的一連串關鍵任務

40. **critical task/activity = 關鍵任務 / 活動**

Practice 79

> “Testing is a **critical task** before launch.”

「測試是推出前的一項**關鍵任務**。」

Practice 80

> “Several critical activities must finish first.”

「幾項**關鍵活動**必須先完成。」

N. PHYSICS — CRITICAL POINT

41. **critical point = 臨界點**

A major scientific term.

Practice 81

> “The substance reaches its **critical point**.”

「這種物質到達其**臨界點**。」

Practice 82

> “Above the critical point, the distinction between liquid and gas disappears.”

「超過**臨界點**後，液體和氣體之間的區別消失。」

critical point — physics = 物質的液相與氣相差異消失的特定溫度 / 壓力條件

42. **critical temperature = 臨界溫度**

Practice 83

> “The material has a low **critical temperature**.”

「這種材料的**臨界溫度**很低。」

Practice 84

> “Superconductivity occurs below the critical temperature.”

「超導現象在**臨界溫度**以下出現。」

Meaning depends on the scientific domain.

43. **critical pressure = 臨界壓力**

Practice 85

> “The gas was compressed beyond its **critical pressure**.”

「氣體被壓縮至超過其**臨界壓力**。」

Practice 86

> “Critical pressure is paired with critical temperature at the critical point.”

「**臨界壓力**和臨界溫度共同界定臨界點。」

O. MATHEMATICS

44. **critical point = 臨界點；駐點相關點**

A mathematical/calculus sense.

Practice 87

> “Find the **critical points** of the function.”

「找出這個函數的**臨界點**。」

Practice 88

> “A critical point occurs where the derivative is zero or undefined.”

「當導數為零或不存在時，可能出現**臨界點**。」

****critical point — calculus = 導數為零或不存在、可能出現極值等重要行為的點****

45. **critical value = 臨界值**

A statistics/mathematics term.

Practice 89

> “Compare the test statistic with the ****critical value****.”

「把檢驗統計量與****臨界值****比較。」

Practice 90

> “The critical value depends on the significance level.”

「****臨界值****取決於顯著水平。」

P. STATISTICS / HYPOTHESIS TESTING

46. **critical region = 拒絕域；臨界區域**

Practice 91

> “The result falls within the ****critical region****.”

「結果落在****拒絕域 / 臨界區域****內。」

Practice 92

> “Values in the critical region lead to rejection of the null hypothesis.”

「落在****拒絕域****內的數值會導致拒絕虛無假設。」

47. **critical significance threshold/value = 臨界顯著標準**

A technical statistical use.

Practice 93

> “The observed value exceeded the critical threshold.”

「觀察值超過了**臨界門檻**。」

Practice 94

> “The critical threshold was set before the analysis.”

「分析前已設定**臨界門檻**。」

Q. NUCLEAR PHYSICS

48. **critical mass = 臨界質量**

A major scientific term with figurative extension.

Practice 95

> “The material must reach **critical mass**.”

「這種材料必須達到**臨界質量**。」

Practice 96

> “Below critical mass, the chain reaction cannot sustain itself.”

「低於**臨界質量**時，連鎖反應無法自行持續。」

critical mass — nuclear = 維持自持核連鎖反應所需的最低裂變物質量

49. **critical mass = enough people/resources to become self-sustaining — 臨界規模；足夠規模**

A major figurative extension.

Practice 97

> “The platform needs a **critical mass** of users.”

「這個平台需要達到足夠的**臨界使用者規模**。」

Practice 98

> “Once the movement reached critical mass, growth accelerated.”

「當這個活動達到**足夠規模**後，增長便加快。」

critical mass — figurative = 足夠多的人 / 資源累積到能令活動自行持續或快速增長的程度

Excellent cross-domain polysemy.

R. NUCLEAR REACTORS

50. **critical = sustaining a nuclear chain reaction — 達到臨界的**

A specialist nuclear sense.

Practice 99

> “The reactor became **critical**.”

「反應堆達到**臨界狀態**。」

Practice 100

> “A critical reactor sustains a steady chain reaction.”

「處於**臨界狀態**的反應堆能維持穩定連鎖反應。」

Important:

In nuclear physics:

> **critical does not mean dangerous**

It means:

> the chain reaction is self-sustaining.

Very important technical distinction.

51. **subcritical / supercritical — 次臨界 / 超臨界**

Practice 101

> “The system remained **subcritical**.”

「系統保持在**次臨界狀態**。」

Practice 102

> “Under some conditions, the reactor can become supercritical.”

「在某些條件下，反應堆可能進入**超臨界狀態**。」

These are technical family extensions.

S. FLUIDS / THERMODYNAMICS

52. **supercritical fluid = 超臨界流體**

Practice 103

> “Carbon dioxide can become a **supercritical fluid**.”

「二氧化碳可以變成**超臨界流體**。」

Practice 104

> “Supercritical fluids have properties of both liquids and gases.”

「**超臨界流體**具有液體和氣體的部分特性。」

T. OPTICS

53. **critical angle = 臨界角**

Practice 105

> “Total internal reflection occurs above the **critical angle**.”

「當入射角大於**臨界角**時會發生全內反射。」

Practice 106

> “The critical angle depends on the two materials.”

「**臨界角**取決於兩種材料。」

U. ENGINEERING / LOADS

54. **critical load = 臨界載荷**

Practice 107

> “The structure failed above the **critical load**.”

「結構在超過**臨界載荷**後失效。」

Practice 108

> “Engineers calculated the critical buckling load.”

「工程師計算了**臨界屈曲載荷**。」

55. **critical speed = 臨界速度**

Practice 109

> “The rotating shaft has a **critical speed**.”

「旋轉軸有一個**臨界速度**。」

Practice 110

> “Vibration can increase near critical speed.”

「接近**臨界速度**時，振動可能增加。」

Technical meaning varies by system.

V. SOFTWARE / COMPUTING

56. **critical error = 嚴重錯誤；致命錯誤**

Practice 111

> “The program stopped because of a **critical error**.”

「程式因**嚴重錯誤**而停止。」

Practice 112

> “A critical error can make the system unusable.”

「**嚴重錯誤**可能令系統無法使用。」

critical = severity high enough to threaten normal operation

57. **critical failure** = 關鍵故障；嚴重失效

Practice 113

> “The server experienced a **critical failure**.”

「伺服器發生了**嚴重故障**。」

Practice 114

> “Backup systems prevented a critical failure.”

「後備系統防止了**重大失效**。」

58. **critical vulnerability** = 嚴重漏洞

You have already seen **vulnerability**.

Practice 115

> “The update fixes a **critical vulnerability**.”

「這次更新修補了一個**嚴重安全漏洞**。」

Practice 116

> “Critical vulnerabilities should be patched immediately.”

「**嚴重漏洞**應立即修補。」

Here **critical** means:

> highest/very severe security impact

not “analytical”.

W. ALERT / PRIORITY LEVEL

59. **critical priority/severity** = 最高 / 極高優先級；嚴重等級

Practice 117

> “The ticket was marked **critical**.”

「這張工單被標記為**最高嚴重級別**。」

Practice 118

> “Critical incidents require immediate response.”

「**重大事故**需要立即處理。」

Common in:

- * IT
- * operations
- * incident management
- * safety systems

X. BUSINESS / FINANCE

60. **critical business function** = 關鍵業務功能

Practice 119

> “Payments are a **critical business function**.”

「付款處理是一項**關鍵業務功能**。」

Practice 120

> “The plan identifies critical functions that must remain operational.”

「計劃識別出必須保持運作的**關鍵功能**。」

61. **critical dependency = 關鍵依賴項**

Practice 121

> “The supplier is a **critical dependency**.”

「這個供應商是一項**關鍵依賴**。」

Practice 122

> “The review identified several critical dependencies.”

「檢討找出了幾項**關鍵依賴因素**。」

Y. THRESHOLD / TURNING POINT

62. **critical point = 關鍵時刻；轉折點**

A general figurative use separate from the scientific term.

Practice 123

> “Negotiations have reached a **critical point**.”

「談判已到達**關鍵時刻 / 轉折點**。」

Practice 124

> “The situation is approaching a critical point.”

「情況正接近一個**關鍵臨界點**。」

critical point — general = 再往前發展就可能產生重大改變或結果的時刻

63. **critical threshold = 關鍵門檻；臨界值**

Practice 125

> “Demand has passed a **critical threshold**.”

「需求已超過一個**關鍵門檻**。」

Practice 126

> “Below the critical threshold, the system remains stable.”

「低於**臨界門檻**時，系統仍保持穩定。」

Z. TIME

64. **critical period = 關鍵期；臨界期**

Practice 127

> “Early childhood is a **critical period** for language development.”

「幼兒期是語言發展的**關鍵期**。」

Practice 128

> “The first few hours are a critical period for treatment.”

「最初幾小時是治療的**關鍵時段**。」

critical period = 某種發展 / 結果對時間特別敏感的重要時段

65. **critical window = 關鍵窗口期**

Practice 129

> “There is a **critical window** for intervention.”

「干預有一個**關鍵窗口期**。」

Practice 130

> “Missing the critical window may reduce effectiveness.”

「錯過**關鍵時機**可能降低效果。」

AA. LANGUAGE / DISCOURSE

66. **critical discourse analysis = 批判性話語分析**

A specialist academic term.

Practice 131

> “The research uses **critical discourse analysis**.”

「這項研究採用**批判性話語分析**。」

Practice 132

> “Critical discourse analysis examines links between language and power.”

「**批判性話語分析**研究語言與權力之間的關係。」

Specialist:

* linguistics

* social sciences

67. **critical theory = 批判理論**

A formal academic term.

Practice 133

> “The course introduces **critical theory**.”

「這門課介紹**批判理論**。」

Practice 134

> “Critical theory examines structures of society and power.”

「**批判理論**研究社會與權力結構。」

Important:

Here **critical** has a specialized intellectual tradition, not simply “negative”.

AB. LITERARY / CULTURAL STUDIES

68. **critical perspective** = 批判性觀點；分析視角

Practice 135

> “The article offers a feminist **critical perspective**.”

「這篇文章提供了一個女性主義的**批判視角**。」

Practice 136

> “Students compare several critical perspectives.”

「學生比較幾種不同的**批判性觀點**。」

69. **critical framework** = 批判分析框架

Practice 137

> “The study applies a new **critical framework**.”

「研究採用一個新的**批判分析框架**。」

Practice 138

> “The framework helps analyse cultural assumptions.”

「這個框架有助分析文化假設。」

AC. EXAMINATION / COMMENTARY

70. **critical essay** = 批判性論文；評論文章

Practice 139

> “She wrote a **critical essay** on the novel.”

「她寫了一篇關於該小說的**批判性評論文章**。」

Practice 140

> “A critical essay should develop an argument rather than merely summarize.”

「**批判性論文**應發展論點，而不只是摘要內容。」

AD. CRITICAL FACULTY / JUDGEMENT

71. **critical judgement = 批判判斷力；審辨能力**

Practice 141

> “Good research requires **critical judgement**.”

「好的研究需要**批判判斷力**。」

Practice 142

> “Students must exercise critical judgement when choosing sources.”

「學生選擇資料來源時必須運用**審辨能力**。」

72. **critical eye = 批判 / 挑剔的眼光**

A common figurative expression.

Practice 143

> “Read your own work with a **critical eye**.”

「要用**審慎挑剔的眼光**閱讀自己的作品。」

Practice 144

> “She examined the design with a critical eye.”

「她以**批判性的眼光**審視設計。」

This can mean:

- * analytical
- * fault-finding

depending on context.

AE. EXTREMELY IMPORTANT RESOURCE / SHORTAGE

73. **critical shortage = 嚴重短缺**

Practice 145

> “The hospital faces a **critical shortage** of staff.”

「醫院面臨**嚴重人手短缺**。」

Practice 146

> “There is a critical shortage of clean water.”

「潔淨食水出現**嚴重短缺**。」

Here **critical** means:

> severe enough to create serious danger/problem

rather than merely “important”.

74. **critically low = 低至危險水平**

Practice 147

> “Water levels are **critically low**.”

「水位已低至**危險水平**。」

Practice 148

> “Her blood pressure became critically low.”

「她的血壓降至**危險水平**。」

****critically = to a dangerously severe degree****

AF. CRITICALLY IMPORTANT

75. **critically important = 極其重要；至關重要**

Practice 149

> “Accurate information is **critically important**.”

「準確資訊**極其重要**。」

Practice 150

> “Sleep is critically important for learning.”

「睡眠對學習**至關重要**。」

Here **critically** means:

> to an extremely important degree

—not analytically.

AG. CRITICALLY DEPENDENT

76. **critically dependent on = 極度依賴；關鍵上依賴**

Practice 151

> “The system is **critically dependent on** electricity.”

「這套系統**高度依賴**電力。」

Practice 152

> “The service is critically dependent on one supplier.”

「這項服務**極度依賴**單一供應商。」

AH. APPROACHING FAILURE / DANGER

77. **critically damaged = 嚴重受損**

Practice 153

> “The bridge was **critically damaged**.”

「這座橋受到**嚴重破壞**。」

Practice 154

> “Several components were critically damaged.”

「幾個部件都**嚴重受損**。」

AI. IMPORTANT DISTINCTIONS

critical vs crucial

critical

can mean:

- * crucial
- * dangerous
- * analytical
- * disapproving
- * relating to critics

crucial

mainly:

= extremely important to the outcome.

> critical decision

> can mean “非常重要的決定”

> critical review

> can mean “批判性 / 評論性的評論”

Critical is much more polysemous.

critical vs important

important

= has significance.

critical

= so important that the outcome may depend on it.

> important detail

> = 重要細節

> critical requirement

> = 關鍵要求

Critical is usually stronger.

critical vs essential

essential

= absolutely necessary.

critical

= extremely important/decisive.

Something can be critical without literally being indispensable.

critical vs serious

serious

= severe, important, or deserving attention.

critical

in medical/emergency contexts:

= extremely severe, often immediately dangerous.

> serious condition

> = 病情嚴重

> critical condition

> = 病情危殆

****Critical**** is usually more severe.

****critical vs severe****

****severe****

= intense/serious in degree.

****critical****

= potentially decisive, dangerous, or life-threatening.

> severe pain

> = 劇痛

> critical condition

> = 危殆狀態

Different focus.

****critical vs negative****

This is extremely important.

****negative****

= unfavourable.

****critical****

can mean negative, but can also mean analytical.

> critical thinking

> does ****not**** mean:

> negative thinking

It means:

> careful analytical thinking.

critical vs skeptical

skeptical

= doubtful/not easily convinced.

critical

= actively analyse and evaluate evidence.

Good critical thinking can include skepticism, but is not simply disbelief.

critical vs cynical

cynical

= inclined to believe selfish/bad motives.

critical

= analytical and evaluative.

A critical thinker does not automatically assume the worst.

critical vs criticize

critical

adjective:

> “She was critical of the plan.”

= 她批評這個計劃。

criticize

verb:

> “She criticized the plan.”

= 她批評了這個計劃。

critical vs critique

criticize

often:

= point out faults.

critique

= systematically analyse/evaluate strengths and weaknesses.

> criticize a film

> = 批評電影

> critique a film

> = 對電影作系統性評析

A critique need not be negative.

criticism vs critique

criticism

can mean:

* negative comments

* scholarly/artistic criticism

critique

usually:

= structured analysis/evaluation.

In academic contexts, **critique** is often more neutral.

critic vs reviewer

critic

often:

= professional evaluator of art/media or outspoken opponent.

reviewer

= person who writes a review; broader.

Not every reviewer is a professional critic.

critical acclaim — key trap

> **critical acclaim**

does **not** mean:

> 「嚴厲的批評」

It means:

> **professional critics praised the work**

Natural Chinese:

> 評論界好評 / 高度讚譽

This is one of the strongest MCQ traps in the whole family.

critical success vs commercial success

critical success

= critics praised it.

commercial success

= it sold/made money/performed well in the market.

A film can be:

> critically successful but commercially unsuccessful

= 叫好不叫座

or the reverse.

critically — three very different meanings

This is particularly important because your passage uses the adverb.

1. Analytical

> “Think critically.”

= 批判性地思考。

2. Severely

> “He was critically injured.”

= 他傷勢危重。

3. Extremely importantly

> “This is critically important.”

= 這極其重要。

Same adverb, three very different interpretations.

critically review vs criticize

> “Critically review the article.”

does **not** mean:

> 「找出文章所有缺點並批評。」

It means:

> **分析、評估、比較證據，指出優缺點並形成判斷**

Essential academic-English distinction.

critical condition vs stable condition

critical

= immediate danger / life-threatening instability.

stable

= not currently worsening significantly.

These are not necessarily exact opposites medically, but ordinary-language contrast is useful.

critical mass — literal vs figurative

Nuclear:

> minimum quantity for self-sustaining chain reaction

= 臨界質量

Figurative:

> enough people/resources for growth/activity to become self-sustaining

= 足夠的臨界規模

Excellent cross-domain extension.

critical point — general vs mathematics vs physics

General:

> decisive stage

> = 關鍵時刻

Mathematics:

> derivative zero/undefined point

> = 臨界點

Physics:

> special thermodynamic state

> = 臨界點

Same phrase, three domains.

critical value — ordinary vs statistical

Ordinary:

> a value that becomes decisive at a threshold

Technical statistics:

> value separating rejection/non-rejection regions

Natural Chinese often:

> **臨界值**

critical — nuclear sense

This is a major semantic warning:

> “The reactor is critical.”

does **not** automatically mean:

> 反應堆情況危險。

In nuclear engineering it specifically means:

> **the chain reaction is self-sustaining**

= 反應堆處於臨界狀態。

critical error vs ordinary error

error

= any mistake/failure.

critical error

= severe enough to stop or seriously compromise operation.

So **critical** marks severity/importance.

critical infrastructure

This does not mean infrastructure being “criticized”.

It means:

> infrastructure essential to the functioning of society/economy.

Examples:

- * electricity
- * water
- * communications
- * transport

critical path

This does not mean:

> dangerous road/path.

In project management:

> **the sequence of tasks determining the earliest possible project completion time**

= 關鍵路徑.

critical period vs sensitive period

In developmental science:

critical period

often implies a narrower window in which certain development/input is necessary.

sensitive period

often means an especially favourable period, though learning may remain possible later.

The exact scientific distinction varies by field, but they should not be automatically treated as identical.

critical eye

Depending on context:

> “look with a critical eye”

can mean:

1. carefully analytical
2. deliberately looking for weaknesses

So Chinese may be:

* 審慎眼光

* 挑剔眼光

Context decides.

critical in your passage

Your passage says:

> “Looking back, I am grateful that the video went viral ... because it taught me to view social media more **critically** and more calmly.”

Here **critically** definitely does **not** mean:

* negatively,

- * harshly,
- * in a life-threatening way,
- * extremely importantly.

It means:

> **to question how social media affects attention, dependence, self-worth, popularity, criticism and emotional wellbeing instead of simply enjoying its rewards unreflectively.**

Family-extension sweep

Following the fullest-reference style, the useful modern inventory includes:

- * **critical — analytical** = 批判性 / 分析性的
- * **critically — analytically** = 批判性 / 審慎分析地
- * **critical thinking** = 批判性思考
- * **critical analysis** = 批判性分析
- * **critical evaluation** = 批判性評估
- * **critical reading** = 批判性閱讀
- * **critical — disapproving** = 批評 / 挑剔的
- * **critical of** = 對.....持批評態度
- * **critically — disapprovingly** = 批評 / 挑剔地
- * **critical — crucial** = 關鍵 / 至關重要的
- * **critical factor** = 關鍵因素
- * **critical issue** = 關鍵 / 重大議題
- * **critical stage** = 關鍵階段
- * **critical moment** = 關鍵時刻
- * **critical — medical** = 危急 / 危殆的
- * **critical condition** = 危殆狀態
- * **critically ill** = 病危
- * **critically injured** = 傷勢危重
- * **critical care** = 重症醫療
- * **critical — critics** = 評論界的
- * **critical acclaim** = 評論界高度讚譽
- * **critical success** = 評論界成功
- * **critical reception** = 評論界反應
- * **critic — reviewer** = 評論家
- * **critic — opponent** = 批評者
- * **criticism — negative** = 批評
- * **criticism — academic/artistic** = 評論研究
- * **constructive criticism** = 建設性批評
- * **criticize** = 批評
- * **critique — noun** = 批判性評析
- * **critique — verb** = 評析

***mission-critical** = 任務關鍵的
 ***business-critical** = 業務關鍵的
 ***safety-critical** = 安全關鍵的
 ***critical infrastructure** = 關鍵基礎設施
 ***critical path** = 關鍵路徑
 ***critical point — general** = 關鍵時刻 / 轉折點
 ***critical point — math** = 數學臨界點
 ***critical point — physics** = 物理臨界點
 ***critical temperature** = 臨界溫度
 ***critical pressure** = 臨界壓力
 ***critical value** = 臨界值
 ***critical region** = 拒絕域 / 臨界區
 ***critical mass — nuclear** = 臨界質量
 ***critical mass — figurative** = 足以自我維持發展的臨界規模
 ***critical — nuclear reactor** = 達到自持連鎖反應臨界狀態
 ***subcritical** = 次臨界的
 ***supercritical** = 超臨界的
 ***supercritical fluid** = 超臨界流體
 ***critical angle** = 臨界角
 ***critical load** = 臨界載荷
 ***critical speed** = 臨界速度
 ***critical error** = 嚴重 / 致命錯誤
 ***critical failure** = 關鍵 / 嚴重失效
 ***critical vulnerability** = 嚴重漏洞
 ***critical severity/priority** = 極高嚴重 / 優先級
 ***critical period** = 關鍵期
 ***critical window** = 關鍵窗口期
 ***critical theory** = 批判理論
 ***critical discourse analysis** = 批判性話語分析
 ***critical perspective** = 批判性視角
 ***critical judgement** = 批判判斷力
 ***critical eye** = 審慎 / 挑剔的眼光
 ***critical shortage** = 嚴重短缺
 ***critically low** = 低至危險水平
 ***critically important** = 極其重要
 ***critically dependent** = 高度 / 關鍵性依賴

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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critical — analytical	透過分析證據、假設、邏輯及不同觀點作獨立判斷的
critically — analytical	以分析、質疑和評估方式形成獨立判斷地
critical thinking	系統分析資訊、判斷證據並形成合理結論的思考方式

critical — disapproving	明確指出某人 / 某事缺點或問題、帶負面評價的	
critical of X	認為 X 有問題並表達不滿 / 批評	
critical — crucial	對結果具有決定性影響、至關重要的	
critical factor	對結果起決定作用的重要因素	
critical stage/moment	結果可能因此發生重大變化的關鍵階段 / 時刻	
critical — medical	情況極嚴重並可能危及生命的	
critical condition	病情 / 傷勢處於危急、生命可能有危險的狀態	
critically ill/injured	病情 / 傷勢危重	
critical care	為危重患者提供的密集醫療照護	
critical — reviewers	與專業評論家及其評價有關的	
critical acclaim	專業評論界給予的高度讚譽	
critical success	在評論界獲得高度肯定的成功	
critic — arts	專門分析、評論藝術 / 媒體作品的人	
critic — opponent	公開指出某人 / 制度問題的批評者	
criticism — negative	對錯誤、問題或缺點作出的負面評價	
criticism — academic	對文學、藝術等進行系統分析和評論的研究	
critique	有系統地分析和評價優點、缺點、假設和論據	
mission-critical	對核心任務不可或缺、失效會嚴重影響運作的	
safety-critical	失效可能造成重大安全後果的	
critical infrastructure	社會 / 經濟正常運作所必需的重要基礎設施	
critical path	決定項目最早完成時間的關鍵任務序列	
critical point — general	發展至可能產生重大結果 / 轉變的關鍵點	
critical point — mathematics	函數導數為零或不存在等具有重要性質的點	
critical point — physics	物質液相和氣相性質界線消失的臨界狀態	
critical value	決定分類 / 檢驗結果的臨界數值	
critical mass — nuclear	維持自持核連鎖反應所需的最低裂變物質質量	
critical mass — figurative	人數 / 資源達到足以令活動自行持續發展的規模	
critical — nuclear	核連鎖反應剛好能自我維持的狀態	
critical angle	光學中產生全內反射相關的臨界角度	
critical error	嚴重到足以中止 / 嚴重破壞系統運作的錯誤	
critical vulnerability	可能造成極嚴重安全影響的漏洞	
critical period/window	某結果 / 發展對時間特別敏感的關鍵時段	
critical theory	研究並批判社會、文化及權力結構的理論傳統	
critical eye	以分析或挑剔方式審視事物的眼光	
critical shortage	已嚴重到造成重大風險 / 問題的短缺	
critically important	重要程度極高、至關重要	
critically low	低到已造成危險 / 嚴重問題的程度	

For your original sentence

> “Looking back, I am grateful that the video went viral, not because it made me ‘famous’ for a day, but because it taught me to view social media more ****critically**** and more calmly.”

The exact meaning is:

****critically** = 作者不再只被 likes、人氣和爆紅帶來的刺激吸引，而是開始仔細分析社交媒體的好

處、風險、心理影響、注意力依賴、批評文化和自我價值問題，並形成自己的判斷。 **

Natural translation:

> **「回頭看，我很感激那段影片曾經爆紅，不是因為它令我『成名』了一天，而是因為這次經歷教會我用更批判、更冷靜的眼光看待社交媒體。」 **

The highest-value contrasts are:

- > **think critically** → 批判性地思考
- > **be critical of something** → 批評某事
- > **critical issue** → 關鍵 / 重大問題
- > **critical condition** → 危殆狀態
- > **critically injured** → 傷勢危重
- > **critical acclaim** → 評論界高度讚譽
- > **critical success** → 評論界成功
- > **critic** → 評論家 / 批評者
- > **criticism** → 批評 / 評論研究
- > **critique** → 系統性評析
- > **critical path** → 關鍵路徑
- > **critical mass** → 臨界質量 / 足夠臨界規模
- > **critical value** → 臨界值
- > **critical infrastructure** → 關鍵基礎設施
- > **critical vulnerability** → 嚴重漏洞
- > **critically important** → 極其重要
- > **critical thinking ≠ negative thinking** → 批判性思考 ≠ 負面思考